



Gangsta Granny's thoughts

"Yo, this Sony SRS XV800 ain't messin' around, weighin' as much as a heavyweight champ! It's got mad sound, karaoke vibes, and party lights that'll turn your crib into a club. But if you're lookin' for a home theater setup, you might wanna check out other joints, 'cause this one's all about the party scene."

PERFORMANCE

The Sony SRS XV800 packs three tweeters, two 170 mm woofers, and two rear tweeters that work in conjunction to provide 360-degree sound, according to Sony. I used it primarily in Bluetooth mode while connected to the Samsung Galaxy S23 Ultra with LDAC codec active. The speaker also has Sony's DSEE technology that upscales music to bring it close to lossless levels. Upon first listen, the Sony SRS XV800 impressed me with its energetic and loud sound.

There's definitely a bias towards the bass regions, however, not enough for it to sound muddy or dark, which is great. The Mega Bass mode adds

a bunch of extra weight to the lows, but it tampers with the quality of the mids. It's good for parties though where you'd want the bass to get a bit more boomy. However, in the default setting, the speaker had a pleasant sound signature with weighty and impactful bass, clear mids and vocals, and decent high reproduction.

However, I don't think the sound signature works too well in a home theatre setup. Sure, it's loud but the bass bias means that dialogue is not given as much importance, which is extremely important when you're watching TV shows or movies at home. There are several better options in the market at the same price.

The room-filling ability of the Sony SRS XV800 cannot be denied though. Its high-excursion woofers comfortably let it get loud enough for most indoor parties. However, crank it up to the maximum and you're going to hear some distortion creep in. Regardless, you won't need to crank the volume up to the maximum level at most times.

As for battery life, Sony promises 25 hours of continuous playtime. In our tests, the Sony SRS XV800 comfortably managed 22 hours with LDAC codec active and at 50 per cent volume, which is impressive. There's also fast charging support where a quick 10-minute charge will get you 3 hours' worth of playtime.

VERDICT

The Sony SRS XV800 is an impressive party speaker with impactful bass response and the ability to get extremely loud, however, it's not the best home theatre solution in its price range. You can get cheaper soundbars that will sound better in your home theatre setup. Where the Sony SRS XV800 shines is as a party speaker – you've got rich and full-bodied bass response, classy LED lights that sync up with the music, and tons of customisability options via the app. The price is a bit on the higher side though – especially in India where it is not customary to drop close to ₹50,000 on a speaker.

–Dhriti Datta

SPECIFICATIONS

Number of speakers: Tweeter units: 3, Woofer units: 2, Rear tweeter units: 2 | Speaker size: Approx. 60 mm Tweeter, Approx. 170 mm Woofer, Approx. 40 mm Rear Tweeter | Dimensions (W x H x D): 317 mm x 720 mm x 375 mm | Weight: Approx. 18.5 kg | Bluetooth version: 5.2 | Codecs: SBC, AAC, LDAC | Frequency range: 20 Hz - 20,000 Hz (44.1 kHz sampling) | I/O: Stereo Mini Jack (IN), USB A, Optical Digit Input, Mic input, Guitar Input | Compatible app: Sony Music Center / Fiestable | Battery life: Approx. 25 hours | Power consumption: Approx. 77 W | IP rating: IPX4 (when placed vertically) IPX2 (when placed horizontally)

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